MOHAMMAD ASIF KHAN, PhD

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Two decades · 6 countries · Founding Dean & Centre Director · ~USD 4.1M directed · 8 programmes built · 70+ keynotes · h-index 30 · 3,850+ citations

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP PROFILE

Senior academic and research leader with more than two decades of institution-building across six countries at the intersection of **bioinformatics, data science, and AI**. Founding Dean of the first School of Data Sciences in Malaysia, Founding Director of a national bioinformatics centre, and currently **Professor and Associate Dean** at the University of Doha for Science and Technology, where I chair the University's ranking working group and contribute to college-wide accreditation and curriculum. Founder of two ventures, **Editor-in-Chief** of a major Elsevier reference work, and an elected leader of the global bioinformatics community (*ISCB Honorary Director*; *APBioNET Vice President*; *GOBLET Chair*). I have attracted and directed ~USD 4.1M in research and institutional funding, led or co-led the development of eight academic programmes, contributed to multiple accreditations, and translated research into tools, patents, and partnerships spanning academia, industry, and government.

CORE LEADERSHIP COMPETENCIES

Institution & Programme Building · Research & Innovation Strategy · AI / Data Science Leadership · **Accreditation & Academic Quality (ABET, MQA)** · Global Partnerships & Consortia

Governance & Board Service · Academic Entrepreneurship (P&L) · Cross-sector & International Leadership · **Talent Development & Mentorship**

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Professor & Associate Dean, CCIT | University of Doha for Science & Technology, Qatar *2023 – Present*

- Deputise for the Dean on academic matters across the College; **chair or vice-chair 12+ college and university committees** spanning accreditation, curriculum, recruitment, quality assurance, and capstone.
- **Chair, UDST THE/QS Ranking Working Group** — set and drive the institution's global-ranking strategy.
- Vice Chair, CCIT Accreditation Taskforce; **contributed to ABET accreditation** of the BSc in Information Systems and BSc in Information Technology.
- Chair, UDST Capstone Projects Committee (2024–Present) — university-wide; steers interdisciplinary capstone work in partnership with industry.
- Founding Convenor (2024), Centre of Excellence in Bioinformatics.

Founding Dean, School of Data Sciences | Perdana University, Malaysia *2016 – 2019*

- Established and led the **first School of Data Sciences in Malaysia**; built faculty, curriculum, and postgraduate programmes from inception.
- Senate member; later appointed Chief Data Officer of the University.
- Secured programme accreditation and positioned data science as a strategic institutional pillar.

Founding Director, Centre for Bioinformatics (PU-CBi) | Perdana University, Malaysia *2014 – 2016*

- Founded and directed the University's bioinformatics centre, building research capacity, funding, and international partnerships.
- Delivered as part of the **JHU–Perdana Public-Private Partnership** under Malaysia's Prime Minister's Department.

Founder & CEO — Alterquo (Malaysia); Co-Founder — BioAct (Türkiye) | Academic ventures *2017 – 2023*

- Founder & CEO of **Alterquo** (university spin-off in high-dimensional data services), with full strategic and operational responsibility; Co-Founder and advisor to **BioAct** (clinical-informatics start-up).

Professor (secondee) & TÜBİTAK International Fellow | Bezmialem Vakıf University (BILSAB), Istanbul, Türkiye *2020 – 2023*

- Awarded the **TÜBİTAK International Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers** (with research grant); built viral-diversity analytics capability and mentored a cross-border team.

Faculty / Adjunct & Visiting Scientist | Johns Hopkins University, USA *2010 – 2017*

- Selected to the **pioneer team** establishing Perdana University under a JHU collaboration; maintained a JHU faculty affiliation while building capacity in Malaysia.

GOVERNANCE, EDITORIAL & GLOBAL LEADERSHIP

- **Editor-in-Chief**, Encyclopedia of Bioinformatics & Computational Biology, 2nd ed. (Elsevier, 2025); Section Editor, 1st ed. (2018; 334 peer-reviewed contributions).
- **Honorary Director**, International Society for Computational Biology (ISCB), 2025 – Present.
- **Vice President (Operations) & Immediate Past President, Asia-Pacific Bioinformatics Network (APBioNET); Founding Chair, Steering Committee, 1st Asia & Pacific Bioinformatics Joint Congress (APBJC 2024, Okinawa), uniting 15 regional organisations; brokered the 2024 APBioNET–ISCB Memorandum of Understanding.**
- **Chairperson & elected Executive Board member**, GOBLET (Global Organisation for Bioinformatics Learning, Education & Training).
- **Founder & Lead**, Bioinformatics Grand Challenges Consortium (BGCC); Associate Editor, Frontiers in Genetics / Bioengineering & Biotechnology.
- **Vice President & Immediate Past President**, Association for Medical & Bio-Informatics, Singapore (AMBIS).
- **External thesis examiner** for 16 PhD/MSc examinations across ten universities in five countries; reviewer for numerous journals, conferences, and funding agencies.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS & ORGANISATIONAL IMPACT

- Attracted **~USD 4.1M in research and institutional funding** (~USD 2.4M directly managed) across ~35 local and international grants.
- Led or co-led the development of **eight academic programmes** (undergraduate, postgraduate, and diploma) as Program Director, Board of Studies chair, or new-programme taskforce chair, and contributed to four others, two currently in development. Led some programme accreditations and supported others (MQA, 2017; ABET at UDST).
- Founded and directed **two research entities and two ventures** across Malaysia, Türkiye, and Qatar.
- Delivered 70+ invited keynotes and plenaries in a dozen-plus countries; organised 80+ international conferences, workshops, and meetings; leads 10 data-science interest groups spanning close to 1,000 practitioners across the Asia-Pacific region.
- Honours: **Outstanding Academic Leadership & Capacity Building Award** (APBioNET–AMBIS–BIC30, NUS, 2026); **TÜBİTAK International Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers** (2020–2023); two Best Paper Gold awards (InCoB 2017); Zuckerkandl Prize (2003, as co-author).

RESEARCH & SCHOLARLY IMPACT (CONDENSED)

- **90+ peer-reviewed publications**; 3,850+ citations; h-index 30; i10-index 49 (Google Scholar).
- **Three granted US patents**; 20+ bioinformatics tools and databases developed or co-developed.
- **Graduated 16 doctoral and master's researchers; mentored 100+; taught nearly 3,000 students across four countries.**

EDUCATION

- **PhD, Bioinformatics** — National University of Singapore (2010)
- **MSc, Bioinformatics** — National University of Singapore (2005)
- **BAppSc (Hons), Biotechnology** (minor in Scientific Computation & Multimedia Communication) — NUS (2003)
- **Nationality: Singaporean · Languages: English, Malay & Urdu (written & spoken) · Hindi (spoken) · Arabic (read & written)**

A full academic curriculum vitae (publications, grants, teaching, and service in detail) is available on request.